# The Noble Dhāraṇī Called Kanakavatī

Āryakanakavatīnāmadhāraṇī · Toh 924 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་གསེར་ཅན་ཞེས་བྱ་བའི་གཟུངས།

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called Kanakavatī, known in Sanskrit as Āryakanakavatīnāmadhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Pakpa Serchen Zhejawé Zung, takes its name from a word meaning "she who possesses gold." It is a dhāraṇī, a short scripture centered on a protective incantation, framed as a discourse of the Buddha. It opens with the Blessed One dwelling in an enclosure-like place together with the great yakṣa general Vajrapāṇi, when Śakra, lord of the gods, approaches and confesses that in battle he is overcome by the illusions, spells, secret mantras, and potions of the asuras. He asks the Buddha, out of love and care for the gods, for a means to crush these hostile forces, and the text is concerned with providing that protection. It is Toh 924 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the dhāraṇī texts gathered in the canon's collections of protective incantations.

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In the language of India: ārya kanakavati nāma dhāraṇī

In the language of Tibet: The Noble Dhāraṇī Called Kanakavatī.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was dwelling in a place like an enclosure, together with the great yakṣa general Vajrapāṇi. Then Śakra, lord of the gods, went to where the Blessed One was. When he arrived, he bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and sat down to one side. Seated to one side, Śakra, lord of the gods, said this to the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, do you know that when I go to the battlefront and wage war, I am defeated by the illusions, the spells, the secret mantras and the potions of the asuras? Blessed One, in order to take us under your care, out of love for us, and in order to utterly crush and utterly destroy the illusions, spells, secret mantras and potions of the asuras, please teach well the great secret mantra of great victory."

Then the Blessed One said this to Śakra, lord of the gods: "Kauśika, it is just so. It is just so that when you join battle with the asuras, you are defeated by their spells, their secret mantras and their potions. Kauśika, out of compassion I shall here pronounce a vidyā-mantra. I shall teach the vidyā-mantra that paralyzes all illusions, turns back all spells, paralyzes all secret mantras,

completely pacifies all fighting, quarrels, fault-finding, combat and warfare, and cuts through all secret mantras and potions."

Then at that time the Blessed One spoke the great vidyā-mantra Kanakavatī: "For three countless eons the other non-Buddhists (tīrthikas), the carakas, the wandering ascetics and the naked ascetics, thought ill of me and created obstacles. From that time on I turned back all the spells of those possessed of illusion and brought the six perfections to completion. I have taught that great vidyā which utterly crushes the illusions, spells, secret mantras and potions of the other non-Buddhists, the carakas, the wandering ascetics, the naked ascetics and the harmful ones, and all the hosts of Māra. Kauśika, in order to take all sentient beings under your care, hold this great secret mantra, the great victorious one!"

"Blessed One, it is so," he replied, and Śakra, lord of the gods, listened to the Blessed One. Then at that time the Blessed One spoke this great vidyā-mantra Kanakavatī:

tadyāthā oṃ hini hini hili hili mili mili hili mili nihi nihi nihira vini kāñcanāpati lokāmāte bhute bhukuta mantra adhikṛte vede vede veta mantra adhikṛte hana hana hasa hasa cchindha cchindha bhindha bhindha bhagavati jaye vijaye jambhani stambhani bandhani mohani amoghaśaktridhāraṇi gṛhṇa gṛhṇa kāḍamamānasi jambhaya jambhaya bhañjaya bhañjaya stambhaya stambhaya bhandhaya bandhaya mohaya mohaya

the illusions of gods, the illusions of nāgas, the illusions of yakṣas, the illusions of rākṣasas, the illusions of garuḍas, the illusions of gandharvas, the illusions of asuras, the illusions of kinnaras, the illusions of mahoragas, the illusions of vidyādharas, the illusions of the accomplished kings of the vidyādharas, the illusions of sages, the illusions of sentient beings and of all vidyādharas, the illusions of bhūtas, all illusions:

rala rala rajja rajja dhuma dhuma dhudhuma rāva rāva rāvana cakrānanta grānthani hana hana sarva vidyā śatrūṇāṃ stambhaya vāyuṃ stambhaya sūryāṃ stambhaya somaṃ stambhaya varuṇāṃ stambhaya agniṃ stambhaya uddakaṃ dhiti dhiti dhāraṇī pāśa haste peṣṭaya pāśane

all those who oppose me, enemies, those with hostile and fiercely hostile minds, those who fight and fiercely fight, all who wish me harm:

hana hana daha daha paca paca bhañjaya bhañjaya jambhaya jambhaya stambhaya stambhaya bandhaya bandhaya mohaya mohaya mahāmohani

bhagavati svāhā

Protect me, protect me from all fears, harms and contagious diseases! phaṭ svāhā

"Kauśika, if any son of good family or daughter of good family, king or great royal minister keeps this Kanakavatī vidyā-mantra in mind, no fear from adversaries will arise for him. His army will not be overcome by the hosts of enemy troops. He will not be overcome by gods, nor by nāgas, nor by yakṣas, nor by rākṣasas, nor by gandharvas, nor by asuras, nor by garuḍas, nor by kinnaras, nor by vidyādharas, nor by ḍākinīs. He will not die an untimely death. He will not be overcome by spells, secret mantras or potions. He will not be overcome by the hosts of enemy troops. He will not meet his death at the hands of the hosts of enemy troops. Weapons will not harm his body. Fire, water, poison, spells, spells, secret mantras and potions will not harm his body. Whoever has done evil, caused it to be done, or rejoiced in it, upon that very one it will fall back; to that very one it will return.

"Therefore, Kauśika, if a faithful monk, nun, layman, laywoman, son of good family or daughter of good family recites this vidyā-mantra seven times over water and anoints his own body, his body will be protected. One who wishes to pass completely beyond all fears, all harms, epidemics and all contagious diseases, all spells, secret mantras, all potions and all sorcery should keep this Kanakavatī vidyā-mantra in mind. A king or royal minister who wishes to crush enemy armies and to subdue enemy armies should keep this Kanakavatī vidyā-mantra in mind. Having recited it seven times, one should tie on a thread in which seven knots have been made, or one should protect oneself with water over which it has been recited seven times.

This dhāraṇī, which is unobstructed in the face of all fears, should be written down and carried. It should be tied at the neck. If one writes it down, ties it to the top of a banner and enters battle, one will come through with well-being and happiness. By the power of this vidyā-mantra one will cross over with well-being and happiness, together with one's household, one's servants and attendants, and one's troops. Even what has not been accomplished will be accomplished.

One who wishes to paralyze a vidyā-mantra should recite this seven times over a white thread and tie seven knots in it; the spell will then be bound and paralyzed. One who wishes to paralyze magical illusion should recite this seven times over earth from a charnel ground and scatter it; the illusion will

then be paralyzed. One who wishes to make an opponent speechless at the time of a dispute should recite this seven times over a tilaka mark and apply it; one will then have an answer for every speaker.

It should be read, it should be recited from memory, it should be spoken aloud. By merely speaking it, all misdeeds will be completely pacified. Whatever harm someone has done, and whatever harm someone has intended, will go back to that very person. If one ties on the thread or protects oneself with the water, no vidyā-mantra, no secret mantra and no potion whatsoever can affect one's body. What has not been accomplished will be accomplished, and all of one's aims will turn out favorably.

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, Śakra, lord of the gods, rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

This completes the dhāraṇī called the Noble Kanakavatī.

It was translated and edited by the Indian preceptors Jinamitra and Dānaśīla and the chief editor-translator, the monk Yeshé Dé, and was then revised and finalized according to the new terminology.

## Translator's Notes

• The place where the Buddha dwells, □□□□□□□□□□□, could not be identified with a known Indian place name. It is rendered by its literal sense, "a place like an enclosure."

The Tibetan lists "spells" twice in the list of things that cannot harm the body. The repetition has been kept as it stands.

The list "not by gods … not by ḍākinīs" is read as continuing the preceding "will not be overcome." The clause on untimely death has its own agent (dus ma yin par 'chi bas) and is taken as a separate statement.
• The object over which one recites the mantra to silence an opponent is written □□□□□□□□□□; □□□ is unclear here, and I have rendered the phrase simply as "a tilaka mark." The colophon spells the second paṇḍita's name □□□□□□□□□□, which is evidently Dānaśīla, the usual partner of Jinamitra and Yeshé Dé.

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## Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of

spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.